



KNOW HOW



Q I have a few queries regarding my first installation of Fedora 12 on my PC. Currently, I am using Windows XP SP2, and my mother board is MSI-7191(v1.x), which supports an AMD K8 ATHLON 64FX processor. Does Fedora require the installation of any motherboard driver CD? If it does not, then how will I enable my sound, networking, and enhance my display features? Also, how do I connect to the Internet through my cellphone using PC Suite? It's an EXE file, and I've heard Linux doesn't support this format. Can you tell me where I can get a PDF or Word file that tells me about the Fedora 12 installation process and things I need to do, post installation?

—Dhananjay Sharma,
dhananjaykrm@gmail.com

As far as we know, most of the features work out of the box for MSI-7191 (but you need to install and check this, as we have not tested it). This means that you do not need any additional drivers for your motherboard. Your LAN and sound should also work out of the box.

To connect to the Internet using your mobile, you first need to check that your Linux installation recognises your phone modem. If it does, then you can use any dialler software to connect. Try the NetworkManager program—it's quite easy to use, and you should be able

to go online with it. Google for a how-to; there's plenty of documentation on it. You can even join the Fedora Forum at <http://fedoraforum.org> and search for solutions to the issues that persist on your system. Only when you can't find a solution, post your query to the forum.

As for a Fedora 12 installation guide, you'll find it at: <http://docs.fedoraproject.org/install-guide/f12/en-US/html/>

Q I have installed openSUSE 11.1, and am happy with its performance. I have another machine on my network with Windows XP installed on it. I was trying to share my folder on my Linux machine so that it can be accessed on the Windows PC. I tried to share the folder with the option available on the Nautilus file manager (when you right click on the folder and select *Properties*). However, upon configuring the share this way, it shows an error message. Please suggest a solution for this.

—Tanya Verma, New Delhi

First of all, check that you have the following packages installed on your system: *samba*, *samba-client* and *nautilus-share*. If not, then install them first. Now open the */etc/samba/smb.conf* file in a text editor and add the following lines under the *[global]* section, if they aren't there:

```
usershare allow guests = Yes
usershare max shares = 100
usershare owner only = False
```

Remember, you'll only be able to edit this file as the root user; do not forget to take a back-up copy of the *smb.conf* file before you make any changes to it. Now check whether you have the */var/lib/samba/usershares/*

directory, as configurations get stored here. If you don't, run the following command as the root:

```
mkdir /var/lib/samba/usershares
chgrp users /var/lib/samba/usershares
chmod 1770 /var/lib/samba/usershares
```

The last step is to restart your Samba server, as follows:

```
/etc/init.d/smb restart
```

Now, try to share the folder using Nautilus—it should work.

Q I have got a live CD of openSUSE 11.2, but I don't know how to install it, keeping Windows as it is. Can you please help install it alongside Windows?

—Vikas, clevervikas@gmail.com

To install openSUSE, all you need to do is boot your system using the Live CD and then click on the *Live Installer* icon on your live desktop to start the installation. Follow the on-screen instructions. On the partitioning screen, you can either customise the partitioning, or you can accept the default partitioning.

I would suggest you carefully review the partitioning section to see that openSUSE should install in an empty partition. [If you're unsure—you don't want to wipe out your data by selecting a wrong partition to install openSUSE—take the help of a friend, Google, or let us know about your partition table.] The installer will automatically select your Windows partition and set it up for a dual-boot system. Now follow the on-screen instructions to complete the installation. After it's over, you should have an option to select between Windows and openSUSE when you boot your PC. **END**